



LAKEWOOD CITY COUNCIL MINUTES

Monday, May 18, 2026

City of Lakewood

6000 Main Street SW

Lakewood, WA 98499

<https://www.youtube.com/user/cityoflakewoodwa>

Telephone via Zoom: +1(253) 215-8782

Participant ID: 868 7263 2373

CALL TO ORDER

Mayor Bocchi called the meeting to order at 6:00 p.m.

ROLL CALL

Councilmembers Present: 7 – Mayor Paul Bocchi, Deputy Mayor Patti Belle, Councilmembers Ellen Talbo, Michael Brandstetter, Philip Lindholm, Ryan Pearson and J. Trestin Lauricella.

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE

Mayor Bocchi led the Pledge of Allegiance.

PUBLIC COMMENTS

Judith Anderson, Lakewood resident, spoke about climate change, impacts to wildlife and in support of tree preservation.

James Dunlop, Lakewood resident, spoke about changes to Bus Route 574 and in support of keeping the existing schedule.

Tichomir Dunlop, Lakewood resident, spoke about the Nyanza Road sidewalk project and whether the project was worthwhile to the destruction of trees.

Haley Ivey, Lakewood resident, spoke in opposition to changes to Bus Route 574.

Ebrahim Mirjalili, Lakewood resident, spoke in opposition to funding in support of war.

Christina Manetti, Lakewood resident, spoke in support of enforcement of the Lakewood Municipal code related to noise pollution and in opposition to drive through service windows.

Christina Manetti, Garry Oak Coalition, spoke about the cost of a public records request for records related to city sponsored tree projects.

C O N S E N T A G E N D A

- A. Approval of the minutes of the City Council meeting of May 4, 2026.
- B. Approval of the minutes of the City Council study session of May 11, 2026.
- C. Motion No. 2026-37

Authorizing the execution of an amendment to the agreement with Active Construction, increasing spending in the amount of \$233,745, for additional work performed on the construction of the Steilacoom Boulevard – 87th to Weller Road project.

- D. Motion No. 2026-38

Authorizing the execution of an agreement with NorthStar CG, LP, in the amount of \$297,739, for the demolition of industrial building at 2916 107th Street S.

- E. Motion No. 2026-39

Authorizing the execution of an agreement with CPSM, the amount of \$76,973, for a comprehensive police operational analysis and staffing study.

- F. Items filed in the Office of the City Clerk:
 - 1. Planning Commission meeting minutes of April 15, 2026.

Councilmember Pearson requested Item, No. E, Motion No. 2026-39 be removed from the Consent Agenda.

COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON MOVED TO ADOPT THE CONSENT AGENDA, MINUS ITEM NO. E, MOTION NO. 2026-39. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER LINDHOM. VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON MOVED TO ADOPT ITEM NO. E, MOTION NO. 2026-39. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER TALBO. VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

R E G U L A R A G E N D A

PUBLIC HEARINGS AND APPEALS

This is the date set for a public hearing on the Six-Year (2027-2030) Transportation Improvement Program.

The City Council received testimony in advance from Alan Billingsley, Dan Bronoske, Robert Ezelle, Elli and Al Falk, Eva P. Farrukh, Elizabeth Fortenbery, Garry Oak Coalition, Don and Norma Guenthoer, Jen Imholt, Hannah, Erin Johnson, Omar S Johnson, Kris and Mike Mackey, Kristine Mackey, Christina Manetti, Veronica Niechajczyk, Brian Parsons, Tricia Parsons, Doug Payne, Kurt Reidinger, Sean Rodrigues, Kayla Stewart, Amy Ulrich, Rebecca Wong and Trevor Wong.

Speaking before Council were:

Amanda Mackey, Lakewood resident, spoke in opposition to the 75th Street – Phillips to Custer project.

Amy Ulrich, Lakewood resident, spoke in opposition to the 75th Street – Phillips to Custer project.

Ryan Ulrich, Lakewood resident, spoke in opposition to the 75th Street – Phillips to Custer project.

Helen McGovern, Lakewood resident, spoke about the history of the city and in opposition to in opposition to the 75th Street – Phillips to Custer project.

Liz Scott, Lakewood resident, spoke in opposition to the 75th Street – Phillips to Custer project.

Scott Shields, Lakewood resident, spoke in opposition to the 75th Street – Phillips to Custer project.

Ria Bakker, Lakewood resident, spoke about lack of public communication regarding projects.

Linda Farmer, Lakewood resident, spoke in opposition to the 75th Street – Phillips to Custer project.

Chris Fruitrich, Lakewood resident, spoke in opposition to the 75th Street – Phillips to Custer project.

Patricia and Tyson Fishback, Lakewood residents, spoke in opposition to the 75th Street – Phillips to Custer project.

Annette Hffoller, Lakewood resident, spoke in opposition to the 75th Street – Phillips to Custer project.

Elizabeth Davis, Lakewood resident, spoke in opposition to the 75th Street – Phillips to Custer project.

Mary Moss, Lakewood resident, spoke in opposition to the 75th Street – Phillips to Custer project.

Joel Glover, Lakewood resident, spoke in opposition to the 75th Street – Phillips to Custer project.

AJ Taylor, Lakewood resident, spoke in opposition to the 75th Street – Phillips to Custer project.

Regina Gorden, Lakewood resident, spoke in opposition to the 75th Street – Phillips to Custer project.

Dan Gorden, Lakewood resident, spoke in opposition to the 75th Street – Phillips to Custer project.

Michelle George, Lakewood resident, spoke in opposition to the 75th Street – Phillips to Custer project.

Ebrahim Mirjalili, Lakewood resident, spoke in opposition to the 75th Street – Phillips to Custer project.

Christina Manetti, Garry Oak Coalition, spoke in opposition to the Transportation Improvement Program as presented.

Christina Manetti, Lakewood resident, spoke in opposition to the Transportation Improvement Program.

Paul Brice, Lakewood resident, spoke in opposition to the 75th Street – Phillips to Custer project.

Mike Galden, Lakewood resident, spoke in opposition to the 75th Street – Phillips to Custer project.

Geoff Dillon, Lakewood resident, spoke in opposition to the 75th Street – Phillips to Custer project.

Itzel Lascina, Lakewood resident, spoke in opposition to the 75th Street – Phillips to Custer project., 75th Street – Phillips to Custer project.

Bob Jensen, Lakewood resident, questioned whether there will be another public hearing on the Transportation Improvement Program.

Alexander Misiewicz, Lakewood resident, spoke in opposition to the 75th Street – Phillips to Custer project.

Jake Kronika, Lakewood resident, spoke in opposition to the 75th Street – Phillips to Custer project.

Tichomir Dunlop, Lakewood resident, spoke in opposition to the 75th Street – Phillips to Custer project.

There being no further public testimony, the public hearing was declared closed at 7:58 p.m.

At 7:58 p.m., Mayor Bocchi announced that the City Council will recess for approximately 10 minutes. The City Council reconvened at 8:08 p.m.

ORDINANCE

Ordinance No. 851 Amending the 2025/2026 Biennial Budget.

COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON MOVED TO ADOPT ORDINANCE NO. 851. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER LAURICELLA. VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

RESOLUTION

Resolution No. 2026-03 Authorizing the City Manager to seek grant funding assistance through the Washington State Historical Society Heritage Capital Grant Program.

COUNCILMEMBER BRANDSTETTER MOVED TO ADOPT RESOLUTION NO. 2026-03. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON.

COUNCILMEMBER BRANDSTETTER SECTION 1 TO READ AS FOLLOWS: COMMITMENT OF THE REQUIRED COST SHARE OF A MINIMUM \$2,000,000 THROUGH CITY PROVIDED AND ACQUIRED RESOURCES TOWARD THE REHABILITATION OF THE FORT STEILACOOM PARK H-BARN RESTORATION PROJECT FOR THE \$1,000,000 GRANT REQUEST, GIVEN A MINIMUM PROJECT COST OF \$3,000,000. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON. VOICE VOTE TAKEN AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

VOICE VOTE TAKEN ON RESOLUTION NO. 2026-03 AS AMENDED AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

None.

NEW BUSINESS

None.

ITEMS FOR DISCUSSION**Review of the Downtown Transportation Feasibility Study: Draft Public Participation Plan.**

Angie Silva, Assistant Director, Planning and Public Works provided a high-level overview of the draft Public Participation Plan (PPP) which outlines an engagement strategy for the Lakewood Downtown Transportation Feasibility Study. She reviewed the study area, project scope, key deliverables, engagement strategies and tentative project schedule. Discussion ensued.

Review of the Automated Traffic Safety Camera Program.

Heidi Ann Wachter, City Attorney provided an overview of the feedback provided by the Public Safety Advisory Committee (PSAC) related to proposed parks and school locations for automated traffic safety cameras. She shared graphs comparing collision data and traffic counts for each location. Discussion ensued and the City Council requested a future meeting to discuss and decide on the total number of cameras and locations based on public safety.

REPORTS BY THE CITY MANAGER

City Manager Russell shared that the City traveled to Washington, D.C to meet with federal legislative delegates and the League of Cities to discuss legislative priorities.

He announced the following upcoming meetings and events:

- May 19, JBLM Civic Leaders Tour, McChord Field
- May 21, South Sound Military and Communities Partnership (SSMCP) Elected Officials Council

CITY COUNCIL COMMENTS

Councilmember Lauricella shared that last week he attended a Public Safety Conference in Fort Worth, he spoke about the Nyanza Road

improvements and requested financial information regarding the West Coast Baseball League proposal at Fort Steilacoom Park

Councilmember Pearson shared that he will attend JBLM Civic Leaders Tour, the Pierce County Sewer General Review Committee meeting and Pierce County Regional Council.

Councilmember Lindholm thanked those who provided public comments this evening and shared that he will attend the Community Services Advisory Board meeting.

Councilmember Brandstetter shared that he will attend the South Sound 911 meeting, the Unified Approach to Homelessness meeting and spoke about the Transportation Improvement Program.

Councilmember Talbo shared that the Oakbrook Neighborhood Association meeting is scheduled for May 19th and the Custer Neighborhood is scheduled for May 20th. She spoke about Bus Route 574 and impacts to travelers and shared that last week she attended PSRC Housing Mini Academy.

Deputy Mayor Belle spoke about meetings she attended last week in Washington, D.C., shared that she attended the Youth Council end of year celebration, spoke about the importance of sidewalks on Nyanza Road and thanked those who provided public comments this evening.

Mayor Bocchi shared that last week he attended the Kids Fishing Event at American Lake Park, the Lakewood Rotary event and this week he will attend the Arlington Project and SSMCP Elected Officials Council. He thanked those who provided public comments this evening.

At 9:55 p.m., Mayor Bocchi announced that the City Council will recess into Executive Session for approximately 25 minutes pursuant to RCW 42.30.110(1)(i) to discuss with legal counsel representing the agency litigation or potential litigation to which the agency, the governing body, or a member acting in an official capacity is, or is likely to become, a party, when public knowledge regarding the discussion is likely to result in an adverse legal or financial consequence to the agency. The City Council is not expected to take action following the Executive Session other than to adjourn the meeting. Present for the Executive Session: Mayor Bocchi, Deputy Mayor Belle, Councilmembers Talbo, Brandstetter, Lindholm, Pearson, Lauricella, City Manager Russell and City Attorney Wachter and Human Resources Manager Camus.

The City Council recessed at 9:55 p.m. At 10:19 p.m., Mayor Bocchi announced that the Executive Session will be extended for an additional five minutes. The City Council reconvened at 10:26 p.m.

ADJOURNMENT

There being no further business, the meeting adjourned at 10:26 p.m.



PAUL BOCCHI, MAYOR

ATTEST:



BRIANA SCHUMACHER
CITY CLERK